

SPORTSWEEK

Silver Says

By Charlie Kitts



Grand Theft-Pie...the story unfolds like many television and big screen mysteries...the secure setting...a valuable target...the usual suspects...a wintry night...with stealth and precision the caper comes down...the result - one missing apple pie!...now, many may not consider an apple pie as being of tremendous value...the owner (and baker) of the pie in question considered it a masterpiece...he had great plans for this pie...it was to be a "special" gift for a "friend"...the evidence is not conclusive yet...our resident NFL specialist Bubba was seen with an extra wide grin...it became even wider when discussion of the pie surfaced...the victim of the crime - the very large BSC is handling the "case" himself...results should be forthcoming!

The Shame of It All...for the last four months, the aforementioned BSC and your humble scribe Silver have been engaged in the **Battle of the Bulge**...we have attempted, through reduced menus and no great effort, to see who was the slimmer of the two...as a matter of interest or encouragement we suggested folks guess at the status of our weight differential...we set New Year's Day as the target...Silver won the "popular" vote...of the 80 people who took part, 47 thought that Silver was slimmer!...but, as American politicians will tell you the popular vote isn't always the outcome...the scales had the final vote...the result, Silver is the larger of the two...by 15.85 ounces...the shame of it all...and I didn't even get a piece of the missing pie that was supposed to influence the result...now both of us are going to talk to Bubba...the result of the competition?...three people Shella Schroeder, Ella McPhail, and Sharon Sonnenburg split the pot...and a donation was made to charity...thanks folks, has anyone seen Bubba?

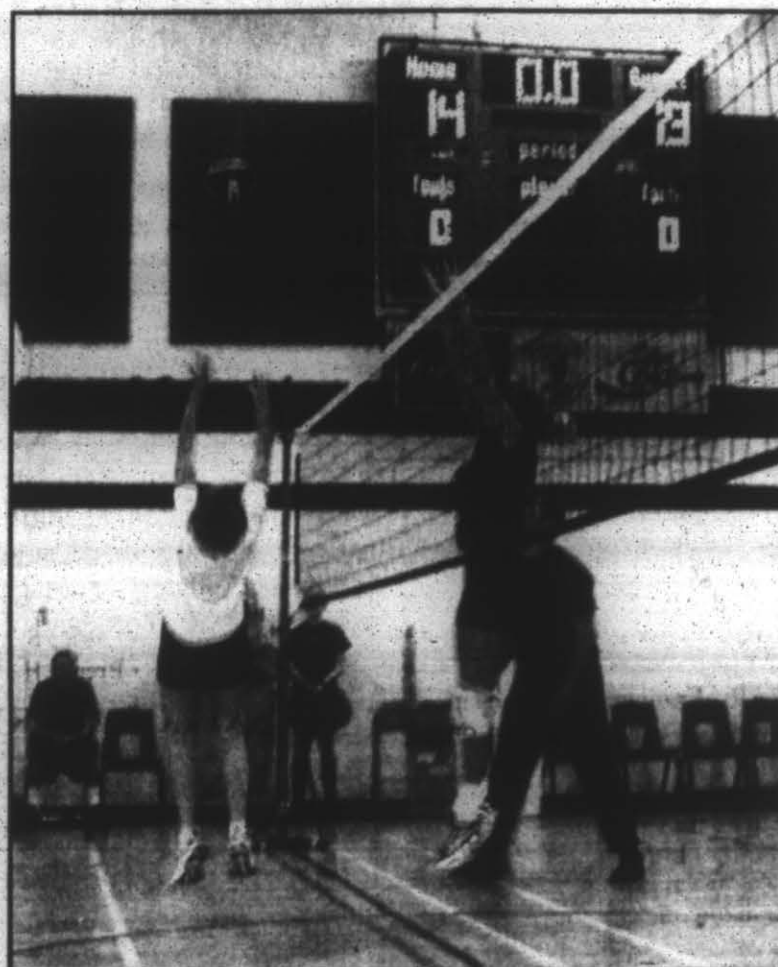
What Do Athletes Do?...most athletes have a training program in the off-season...it often involves strenuous physical activity...and most often can be directly related to their major role in sports...so, what would a young athlete, leader of a national championship football team do...well, you have to stay in shape to call the plays...and where do you "call" in the off-season?...why at bingo of course...so, I guess it was no surprise that quarterback Steve Dalgity was spotted at a local emporium, doing just that over the holidays!...from "touch" football to full contact Bingo - I wonder if there is a rough transition period?

Not Quite National Scale...but still very impressive...the annual holiday "tryathlon" was held once again this year chez Bango...and once again the "mature" athletes defeated the young pretenders...the event attracts some of the area's most serious athletes and has been known to last well into the wee hours before winners are declared...the years "mature" team leaders were Dapper Des and the Horseman...they won 12 of their 15 matchups to lead their team to victory...or, as Des explains it, he won 12 and the Horseman lost three, on their way to the roses...well done lads!...you represent the mature athlete population well!!

To all winter sports teams: Send us your schedules for coverage.



Lynn McNames gets ready to receive the ball during the December 21 Lanark County Ontario Provincial Police (OPP) and Almonte and District High School students charity volleyball game. Approximately \$800 was raised for Take Young People Seriously (TYPS). Photo by Theresa Fritz



An Almonte and District High School student (left) sets the ball nice and high as Lynn McNames and Lanark County OPP Const. Trevor DeJong ready for the block during the December 21 OPP/students charity volleyball game. The OPP won the contest. (Photo by Theresa Fritz)

The cross-country ski season here for MVSC

The recent accumulation of snow in the area has brought a smile to the faces of many families who look forward to strapping on the cross-country skis and getting out into the countryside to enjoy this fun and invigorating sport. The Mississippi Valley Ski Club caters to the needs of this rapidly expanding group of enthusiasts.

Along with weekly outings, the club is also busy organizing participation in a number of local Loppets. This year the club is focusing more than ever on the

needs and desires of the "family" aspect of the sport and invites one and all to join the fun.

Registration for the club is being held on Saturday January 6 in the lower level of the Carleton Place Canoe Club between the hours of 10 a.m. and noon. Individual memberships are \$10 or the whole family can join for only \$20. The sport not only allows the entire family to participate, but is an excellent way to burn off a few of those holiday season pounds. See you on the trails!



These Naismith and Holy Name of Mary hockey players lock up during the schools' hockey game at the Almonte arena on December 21, which Naismith won 8-3. Photo by Brent Dowdall

Carleton Place Kings turned in solid effort at Boxing Day tournament

By Jeff Maguire of The Gazette

PERTH - Despite missing several key players, Carleton Place Kings gave a credible account of themselves during the annual Eastern Ontario Junior B Hockey League Boxing Day tournament played here, Tuesday December 26.

Kings, who qualified for the prestigious tournament for the first time in 23 years, were missing half a dozen regulars due to holiday commitments outside the area. Two others were sidelined by injuries. Also among the missing was head coach Ben Fitzgerald who travelled to his native Newfoundland for the holiday season.

However Assistant Coach Jack Smith said that even with a short bench, his club accorded themselves very well in the eight team, single knockout event.

"Everyone else in the tournament had a full lineup except for us," Smith said. "I think if we'd had our full squad we'd have done as well as anyone."

As it was Kings opened the tournament by winning their preliminary round game 5-2 over Brockville Tikis of the Rideau Division.

Five different players

scored for Carleton Place and veteran goaltender Elliot Mould, a standout of late for Kings, turned in a strong effort between the pipes.

The tournament featured the seven top teams from the EOJBHL's four divisions, plus the host Perth Blue Wings. Except for the host club, teams qualified by being in either first or second place in their respective divisions on the tournament cutoff date, December 4. Kings have led the Valley Division for most of the season, although Shawville Pontiacs pulled to within one point by winning two pre-Christmas games.

In the second game of the tournament's opening round Kemptville 73's of the St. Lawrence Division edged Clarence Creek Castors of the Metro Division 2-1. Game 3 saw Westport Rideaus, the defending tournament champions (they currently lead the Rideau Division), bounce host Perth 5-2. In the fourth and final preliminary round contest Ottawa West Golden Knights of the Metro loop upended Alexandria Glens of the St. Lawrence Division 6-2.

That set the stage for the semi-finals with Carleton Place facing Kemptville in

the first game and Westport and Ottawa West tangling in the second.

The understrength Kings managed to stay with Kemptville, finalists in last year's league playoffs, early in their match. However the 73's superiority in numbers finally overwhelmed Carleton Place. Despite another solid performance in goal by Mould, Kemptville prevailed 4-1 to qualify for the final. Chris Ball netted the only Carleton Place goal.

In the other semi-final, Westport and Ottawa West battled right to the wire with the Rideaus, perennial champions of the Rideau Division, coming away with a tight 5-4 triumph.

That set the stage for another confrontation between Westport and Kemptville, regular playoff and tournament antagonists. In fact the same two clubs met in the final of the 1999 Boxing Day event in Alexandria, with Rideaus coming out on top 4-2.

This time around it was another classic confrontation and, once again, Westport prevailed by two goals, recording a 6-4 victory. Rideaus skated off the ice at the Perth and District Community Centre with their second straight Cy Easterbrook Memorial

Trophy.

Veteran defenceman Nick Langlois was named most valuable player for Carleton Place in their preliminary round win over Brockville. In the semi-final it was winger Chris Ball, a steady scorer for Kings of late, who was selected MVP.

Smith said Perth organizers deserve credit for the smooth way in which they organized and ran the one-day tournament.

"It was very well run and the league (EOJBHL) people were also there to make sure things went smoothly," Smith noted.

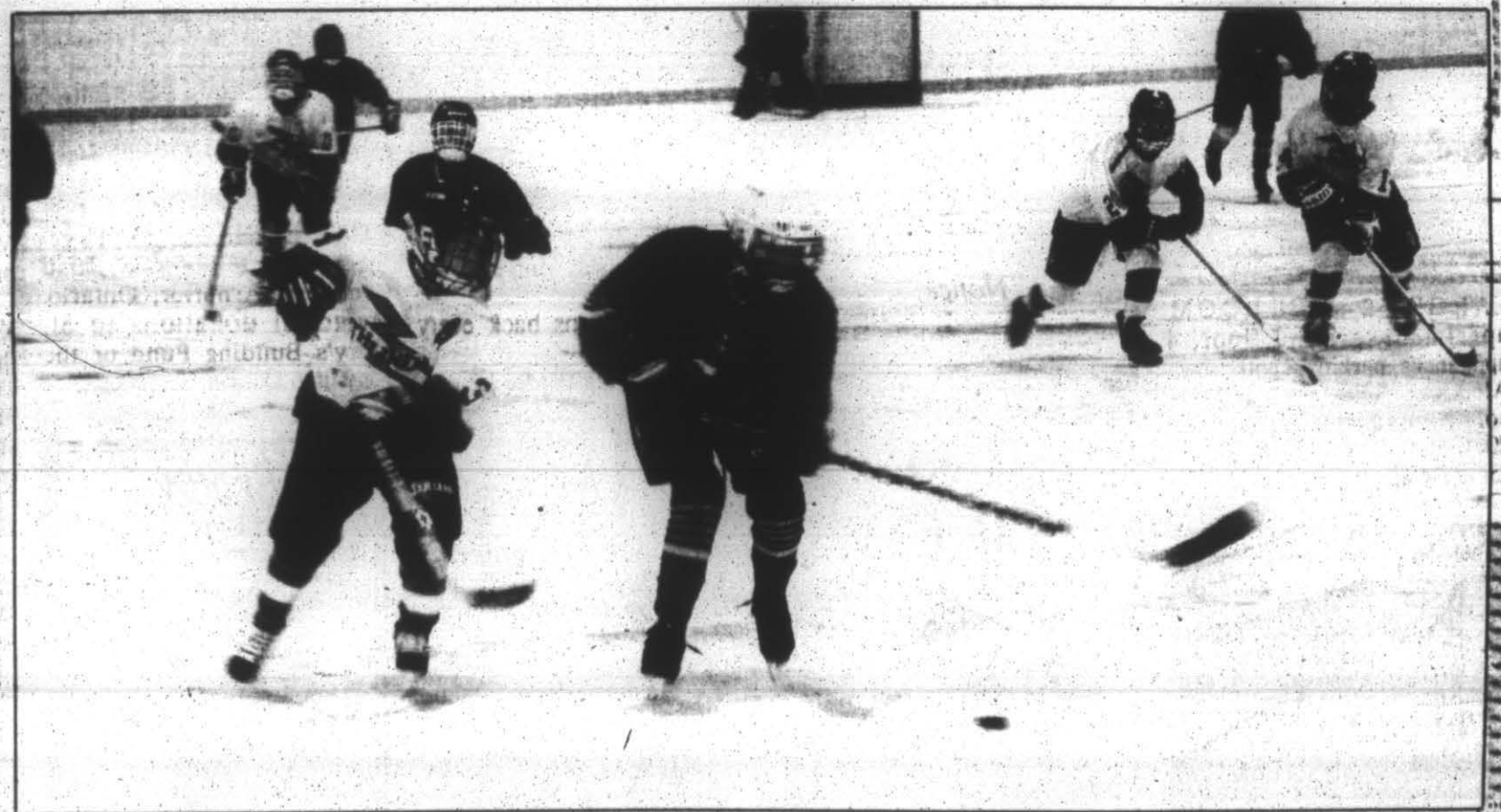
The Carleton Place coach also had praise for the officiating, which he said was good throughout, as well as the sportsmanship shown by the eight teams involved.

"I thought the games were very well played. We only had one penalty in the second game, so that says something," Smith stated.

In fact Kings' coach had only one complaint about the 26th annual Boxing Day event.

"It made the Christmas season a little short," he chuckled.

The last time Carleton Place qualified for the post-Christmas classic was in 1977. Kings went on to win that tournament which was played in Morrisburg.



Aaron Sheridan of the Carleton Place Kings Atom A house league hockey team breaks away from the Almonte/Pakenham Thunder defence and goes in to score the second goal in the Kings' 8-1 tournament victory over the Thunder, in their

semi-final tournament game in Almonte on December 27. Carleton Place reached the B final and lost to Nepean. Almonte lost both their games. Photo by Brent Dowdall



The junior boys volleyball team from Pakenham Public School successfully defended their Lanark County elementary small schools championship December 6. Team members include (front, left to right) Patrick Mears, Clint Drader, Christopher

Branje, Joey Horton, Kurtis Bayford, and (back, left to right) coach Kirk Bellisle, Shawn Barr, Robbie Somerton, Clayton Campbell, Adam Scott, and Duncan White. Photo by Brent Dowdall

If your team is hosting a tournament or a special event in the new year, call us at 256-2167 for coverage.